BUSINESS OPERATIONS / EXECUTIVE CASE

Dragonfly | Building and Scaling a Service Business

From founder-dependent work to repeatable capacity, management routines and decision-making.

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The business and the operating challenge

I helped build and operate Dragonfly Mosquito & Pest Specialists, a family service business that grew to approximately **21 employees, excluding the two family operators**. Growth changed the work. Hiring more people increased demand for structure: training, staffing capacity, routes, equipment, customer follow-through and managers who could make consistent decisions.

My responsibility crossed the service chain: recruiting and coaching; scheduling and field dispatch; customer intake and escalations; estimates and service quality; payroll coordination; vendors, equipment and purchasing; operating procedures and business systems. I worked alongside the other operator rather than holding a formal corporate COO title.

The operating system I helped build

Acquire / intake	Customer questions, estimates and service commitments
Plan capacity	People, customer windows, route density and equipment
Deliver service	Technician readiness, dispatch, field execution and exceptions
Close the loop	Customer communications, quality, payroll and management follow-through

Leadership scope that matters

~21	15 / 5	~25
Dragonfly employees at scale, excluding two operators	Safe Haven team members / geographic markets	TogetherHealth licensed agents supervised

Historical scope and leadership facts reflect firsthand career reporting. The financial analysis on pages 3 and 4 is a separate, contemporary scenario, not Dragonfly financial statements.

Three problems created by growth

01 Workforce scaling and leadership development

Situation. A larger team needs more than informal instruction. Different roles, new hires and frontline leads create competing demands for speed, consistency and accountability.

My work. I recruited and onboarded employees, coached performance, coordinated staffing and addressed readiness and conduct issues. I helped establish clearer training expectations and manager routines instead of relying on constant personal intervention.

Decision principle. Determine whether a problem is a skill gap or an accountability issue, then use the right training, support or performance-management response. Actual financial effects were not quantified.

02 Service capacity, scheduling and dispatch

Situation. Customer time windows, technician availability, travel, service duration and broken equipment competed for the same finite daily capacity.

My work. I handled daily scheduling and rerouting, customer communication, escalations and technician support. When plans changed, I had to weigh what could realistically be delivered before making another promise.

Decision principle. Treat travel, preparation and follow-up as real capacity consumption. Improve how a route works before assuming more headcount is the only answer.

03 Scalable operating infrastructure

Situation. Recurring work creates many handoffs: call intake, quotes, scheduling, dispatch, technician notes, records, payroll, inventory and customer follow-up.

My work. I supported operating procedures, software selection/use, equipment and purchasing coordination, recordkeeping and management expectations. Tools in my broader experience include FieldRoutes, GorillaDesk, PestPac, Jobber, Route4Me, QuickBooks Online, RouteOp, Samsara and Verizon Connect; this is not a claim that all were deployed at Dragonfly.

Decision principle. Give important work a clear process, owner and follow-up path so service quality does not depend on individual memory.

Two independent demonstrations of management depth

Safe Haven Security Services. As Regional Sales Manager, I led approximately 15 representatives across five geographic markets, covering hiring, onboarding, schedules, coaching, performance reviews and representative-to-technician handoffs. I used SecurityTrax, Alarm.com and Excel reporting to connect lead activity to completed installations and customer outcomes.

TogetherHealth. I earned President's Club and ranked first in individual sales among approximately 350 representatives, then supervised roughly 25 licensed professionals. My team ranked first during the Annual Enrollment Period. I managed coaching, training, schedules, call quality and compliance controls, not just volume.

FINANCIAL DESIGN / ILLUSTRATIVE ANALYSIS

The economics of service capacity

The companion workbook evaluates a hypothetical five-technician operating month, separate from historical Dragonfly staffing. The purpose is to show how leadership choices change cost-to-serve, capacity and profitability, not to retroactively claim an income statement.

Editable modeled driver	Base scenario	Why it matters
Demand / field technicians	680 jobs / 5 techs	Tests load against available hours
Onsite + travel time	0.725 h + 0.33 h / job	Both consume paid capacity
Weighted completed-job price	$128.00	Two modeled service lines
Hourly wage + burden	$22.50 + 25%	Modeled loaded payroll
Admin / day + service reserve	1 h / tech + 4%	Allows time for interruptions
Fixed admin + marketing	$23,500 / month	Held separate from per-visit costs

Reconciled representative-month economics

Modeled result	Value	Notes
Completed jobs / demand	680 / 680	At 97% of effective capacity
Revenue	$87,040	680 visits x $128 weighted price
Direct variable costs	$14,249	Materials, travel, fees and visit handling
Loaded technician payroll	$24,750	All paid hours, not counted twice
Fleet and equipment	$2,150	Fixed equipment allocation
Fixed overhead	$23,500	Admin + fixed acquisition/marketing
Operating profit	$22,391	25.7% modeled operating margin

*The model does **not** label contribution EBITDA. Taxes, financing, owner compensation distributions, depreciation, amortization and working capital are outside scope. Unit-level allocated wages reconcile to payroll in the operating statement.*

STRATEGY / SCENARIO COMPARISON

Hire, optimize, expand or reprice?

Demand growth is not the same thing as profitable capacity growth. The scenario engine holds a common financial framework while changing route time, staffing, price or service mix. The following figures are analytical outputs only.

Monthly case	Operating profit	Delta vs baseline
Baseline	$22,391	--
Add one field technician	$24,540	+$2,148
Re-route to free field time	$30,385	+$7,994
Expand to dispersed territory	$14,914	-$7,477
Add adjacent, dense customer demand	$30,385	+$7,994
Raise quoted prices, lose 4% of volume	$24,353	+$1,961
Change mix toward general pest	$23,076	+$685

Operating recommendation

Run a controlled routing-and-demand trial before taking on another fixed labor or geographic obligation. In this illustrative case, route redesign and adjacent-density growth have the most attractive modeled profit, while distant expansion increases travel and creates service backlog even with an extra technician. This is a conditional model recommendation, not a statement that I historically delivered these savings.

Quality gate. In the scenario, some higher-profit choices operate above a 95% utilization warning threshold. That is a management flag: verify travel assumptions, customer time windows, quality, cancellations, safety and technician fatigue before treating any modeled capacity as available.

What this case establishes

My Dragonfly experience was business-building work across people, capacity, customer operations and infrastructure. The new model adds a transparent way to examine business choices: unit economics, resource constraints, scenario comparisons, seasonality, wage sensitivity and assumptions that can be challenged.

Sources and method

Historical basis: firsthand account of role scope, approximately 21 employees and operating responsibilities (no independent company accounting records supplied). **External benchmark:** U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook, Pest Control Workers, May 2025 median hourly wage $21.75 (www.bls.gov/ooh/building-and-grounds-cleaning/pest-control-workers.htm). **Model:** wholly illustrative 2026 scenario, with formulas, provenance and editable inputs in Dragonfly_Operating_Economics.xlsx.

Portfolio: jeffpursley-coder.github.io/dragonfly.html | Workbook and full assumptions: Dragonfly_Operating_Economics.xlsx